

PRELIMINARY DATA: Assessment for Delta Operations on ESA and CESA-listed Osmerids

Last updated: *December 14, 2025*

Executive Summary

Section 11.2.4 of the Proposed Action and Section 8.1.4. of the Incidental Take Permit provide that during Entrainment Management, the California Department of Water Resources, in coordination with Reclamation, shall provide State Water Project (SWP) and Central Valley Project (CVP) operational outlooks and assessments on a weekly basis to the Fish and Water Operations Group (FWOG).

- OMR Season has not yet begun for Delta Smelt but First Flush could occur starting Dec 1
- Freeport flows and turbidity do not indicate First Flush will occur this week
- No Delta Smelt salvage has been observed this water year
- Two Delta smelt releases (hard truck, each 30,000 fish) are expected to occur on 12/2 and 12/3

Operational and Regulatory Conditions

- See current Weekly Fish and Water Operations Outlook document.
- Additional information also available on the [SacPAS SMT page](#).

Environmental Conditions

Weather Forecasts

- **Stockton, CA:**
 - Tuesday Night: A 40 percent chance of showers after 10pm. Mostly cloudy, with a low around 53. Light south southeast wind.
 - Wednesday: A 50 percent chance of showers, mainly before 10am. Mostly cloudy, with a high near 62.
- **Antioch, CA:**
 - Tuesday Night: Rain likely, mainly after 4am. Cloudy, with a low around 56. West wind 8 to 11 mph, with gusts as high as 18 mph. Chance of precipitation is 60%. New precipitation amounts of less than a tenth of an inch possible.

- Wednesday: Rain likely, mainly before 10am. Mostly cloudy, with a high near 60. Chance of precipitation is 60%. New precipitation amounts of less than a tenth of an inch possible.
- Weather forecasts for [Stockton, CA](#) and [Antioch, CA](#) as of December 14, 2025.

Delta Smelt

Biological

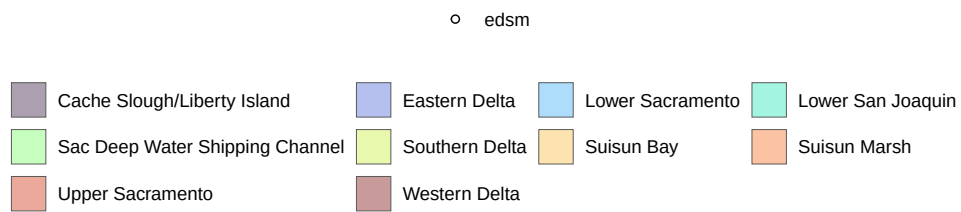
- **Delta Smelt Life Stages:** Adult
- **Abundance estimate:** 3106 (95% CL: 354 to 12,103) as of the week of December 1–5, 2025
- **Releases:** A total of 138,743 hatchery Delta Smelt have been released for WY 2026. The most recent releases of 67,583 fish occurred in Belden’s Landing boat ramp in Suisun Marsh on Nov 05, 2025 to Nov 04, 2025.
- **Delta Smelt count:** 5 adult Delta Smelt and 0 juvenile Delta smelt have been detected this water year. See Table 1 for recent detections, Figure 1 for spatial distribution, and Figure 2 for temporal distribution.
- **Delta Smelt salvage:** 0 Delta Smelt have been salvaged, and the cumulative seasonal salvage is 0.

Notes

- Since there are few recent detections of Delta Smelt, the Smelt Monitoring Team’s capacity to estimate where they are within the Delta is limited.
- See [SacPAS SMT Page](#) for additional details on releases and detection in surveys and salvage.
- Historical salvage trends can be found at: [SacPAS Salvage Timing](#)

Table 1: Delta Smelt Detections in the last 2 weeks. Fork Length > 58mm = Adult, Fork Length 20-58mm = Juvenile, Fork Length < 20mm = Larva.

Survey	Date	Region	Stratum	Life Stage	Catch
edsm	2025-12-01	West	Suisun Marsh	Adult	1
edsm	2025-12-04	North	Sac DW Ship Channel	Adult	1
edsm	2025-12-09	West	Suisun Marsh	Adult	3



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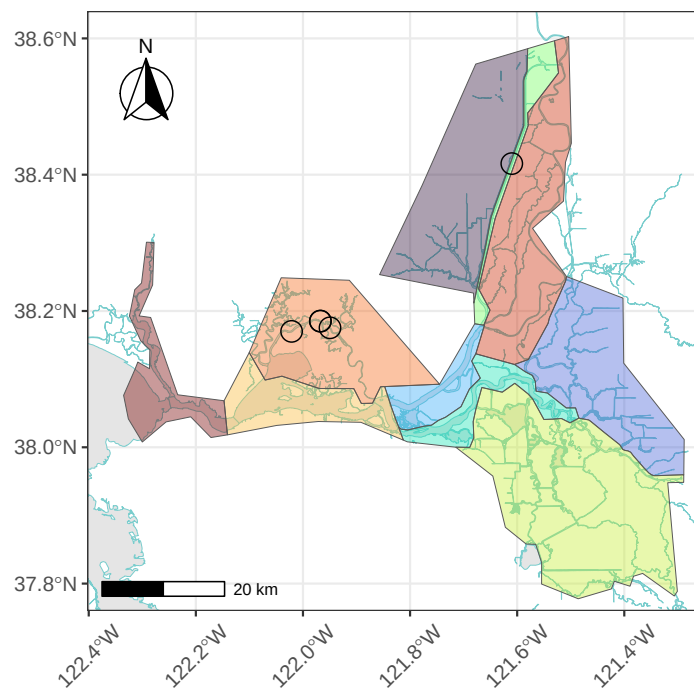


Figure 1: Delta Smelt Distribution for WY 2026

Table 2: Delta Smelt Water Year Totals by Life Stage

Survey	Region	Life Stage	Total
edsm	North	Adult	1
edsm	West	Adult	4

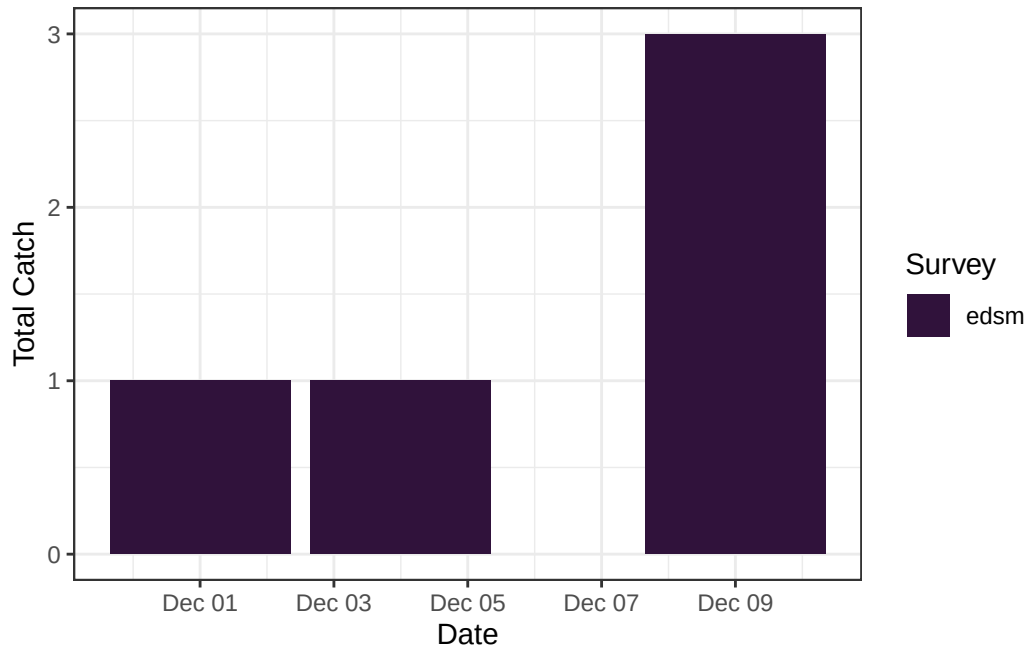


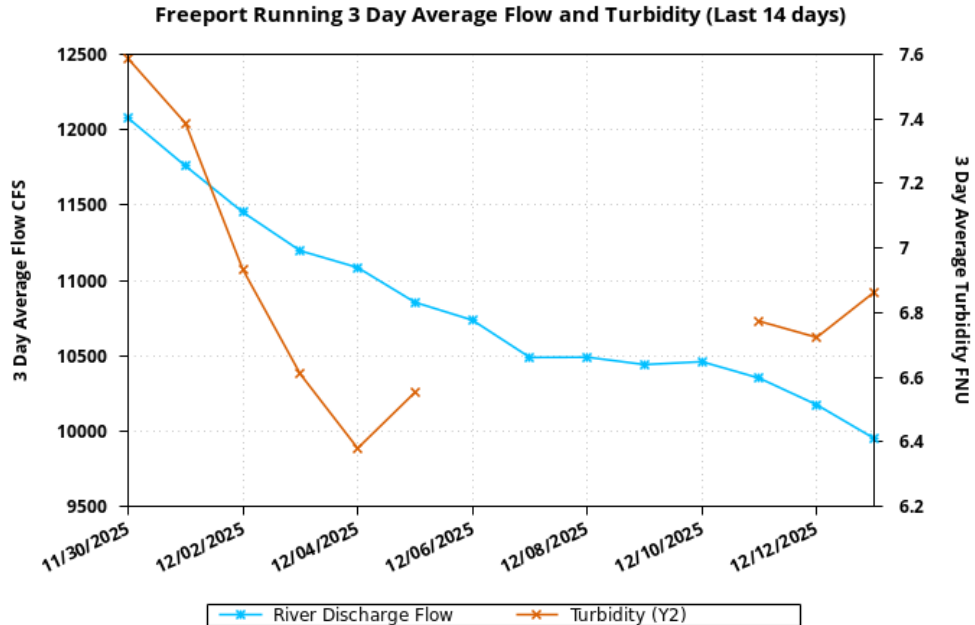
Figure 2: Time Series of Delta Smelt Catch, WY 2026

Environmental

First Flush

Threshold: 3-day avg FPT flow 25,000 cfs and 3-day avg FPT turbidity 50 FNU

- **FPT Flow (3-day average):** 9951.33 cfs as of Dec 13, 2025
- **FPT Turbidity (3-day average):** 6.86 FNU as of Dec 13, 2025



Preliminary data from CDEC; subject to revision.

www.cbr.washington.edu/sacramento/
14 Dec 2025 16:35:01 PST

Real-time Assessment Thresholds

- Jersey Point Flow (JPF): Reclamation and DWR would compute JPF based on San Joaquin River Inflow at Vernalis, Cosumnes River Inflow, Mokelumne River Inflow, Calaveras River Inflow, Flow from Sacramento River through DCC, Flow from Sacramento River through Georgiana Slough, 65% of in-Delta precipitation, -65% of in-Delta diversions, and -Export Pumping at (Banks + Jones).

Adult Delta Smelt

- Threshold: If JPF < 0 AND turbidity is
- Not relevant
- See [Bay-Delta Live](#) for recent Delta-wide turbidity conditions.
- Let's link to wind plot on the other SacPAS SMT page. [Wind plot](#)

Larval/Juvenile Delta Smelt Entrainment Action

- Not relevant

Longfin Smelt

Biological

- **Longfin Smelt Life Stages:** Juvenile
- **Longfin Smelt count:** 0 adult Longfin Smelt and 2 juvenile Longfin smelt have been detected this water year. See Table 3 for recent detections, Figure 3 for spatial distribution, and Figure 4 for temporal distribution.
- **Longfin Smelt salvage:** 0 Longfin Smelt have been salvaged, and the cumulative seasonal salvage is 0.
- Include plot of cumulative longfin salvage? [Salvage plot code](#)

Table 3: Longfin Smelt Detections in the last 2 weeks. Fork Length > 84mm = Adult, Fork Length 20-84mm = Juvenile, Fork Length < 20mm = Larva.

Survey	Date	Region	Stratum	Life Stage	Catch
edsm	2025-12-01	West	Suisun Marsh	Juvenile	2

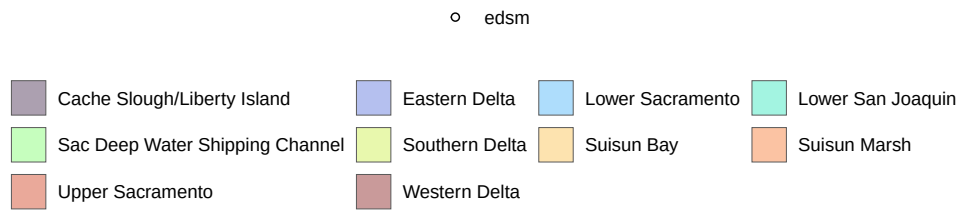
Table 4: Longfin Smelt Water Year Totals by Life Stage

Survey	Region	Life Stage	Total
edsm	West	Juvenile	2

Environmental

Adult Longfin Smelt threshold for start of Entrainment Management

- Threshold: JPF < 0 cfs AND salvage of adult longfin exceeds 26.8 fish (5% of FMWT Index + 1)
 - 7-day average JPF: -524.3434286 as of Dec 11, 2025
 - Water year total Age 1+ longfin smelt salvage = 0



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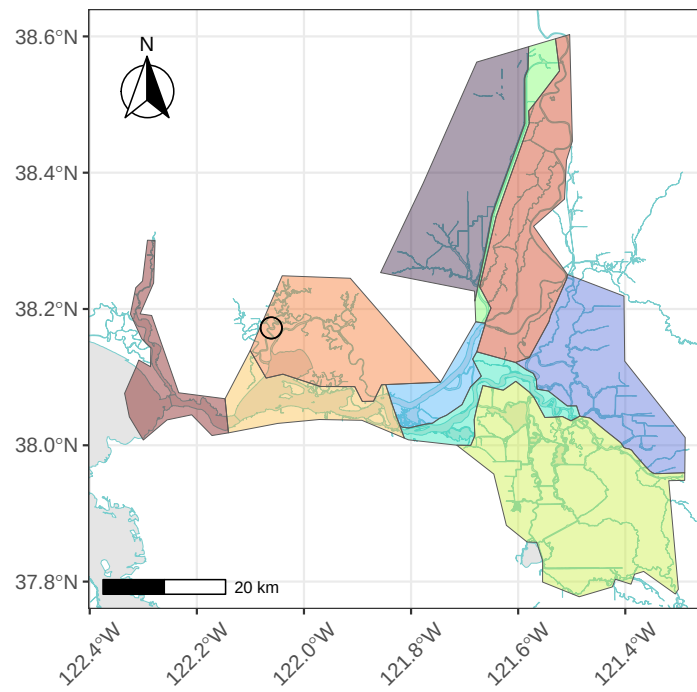


Figure 3: Longfin Smelt Distribution for WY 2026

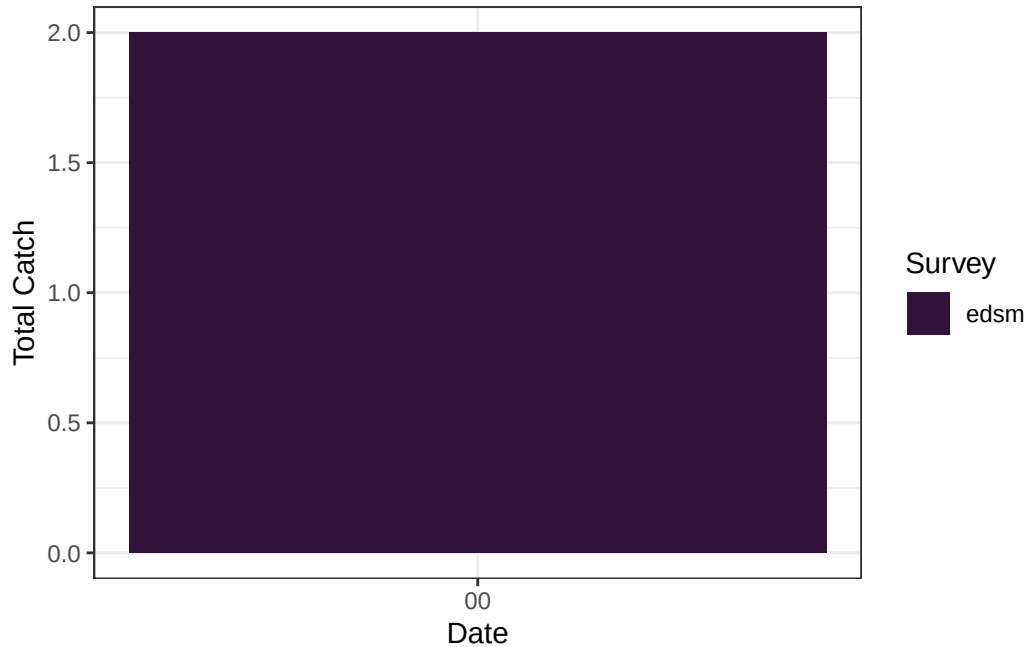


Figure 4: Time Series of Longfin Smelt Catch, WY 2026

Adult Longfin Smelt Entrainment

- Threshold: $JPF < 0$ cfs AND annual loss is on a trajectory to exceed 5% of the adult population abundance
 - 7-day average JPF: -524.3434286 as of Dec 11, 2025
 - 5% of adult population abundance (515.88) = 25.79
 - Water year total adult longfin smelt salvage = 0

Larval/Juvenile Longfin Smelt Entrainment

- Threshold: $JPF < 0$ cfs AND population model demonstrates need to reduce entrainment to avoid population decline
 - 7-day average JPF: -524.3434286 as of Dec 11, 2025

End of Smelt OMR Management

- Not relevant

References